

by the presence of a belief in angels very much like the Fravashis on the side which was independent of ancestor-worship. The same may be said of the "princes" of the nations in Daniel and the Talmud, and the "angels of the Churches" in Rev. 2-3. These Fravashis of communities answer very well to Avestan conceptions. Inasmuch as there seems to be nothing in Israel's native angelology to prompt such a development, it is not unreasonable to suspect a real foreign influence here.¹

Much more serious is the question whether foreign influence affected Jewish demonology. Here I put on one side the popular belief by which demons took in relation to disease very much the position that microbes take for us.² There is no reason for recognising Persian influence of any kind here, though there are some similarities in Persian as in other religious systems. What concerns me more is the possibility that the Magian Ahriman explains the Jewish Satan. It is fairly pointed out that the idea of attributing evil, moral as well as physical, to the agency of a spirit antagonistic to God is late in Jewish thought. One thinks at once of the Chronicler's assigning to a temptation of Satan what the earlier writer attributed to Yahweh.³ Now if we content ourselves with saying that in post-exilic times the Jews knew of a (Magian) theory whereby evil came from a power hostile to God,

¹ For a discussion of Biblical passages involved, see my paper "It is his Angel" in *Journal of Theological Studies*, 1902, p. 514 ff.: also above, p. 274.

² Prof. Jackson remarks that a Zoroastrian priest said the same to him years ago.

³ 2 Sam. 24¹, 1 Chron. 21¹.